



BLACK BUOY
COASTAL WEB CRAFT

WEBSITE AUDIT & REBUILD REPORT

A New Digital Home for The Governor's Inn

What is wrong with governorsinn.com, what it is costing you, and the brand-new website we built to fix it.

PREPARED FOR

The Governor's Inn
78 Wakefield Street
Rochester, NH 03867
governorsinn.com

PREPARED BY

Black Buoy
Web Design & Development
NH Seacoast
blackbuoy.net

DATE

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Short Version

We went through **governorsinn.com** top to bottom, the way a home inspector goes through a house, and scored it against the same 20-point checklist we apply to every site we build. The current site passes 4 of the 20. The page never introduces itself to Google with a heading, carries no description, and contains zero machine-readable information about the inn. Its title tag reads "THERE'S SO MUCH TO THE GOVERNORS INN! - Home", all caps, no location, and the business name spelled without its apostrophe. Under the hood sit seventeen 1990s-era font tags and four layout tables.

Rather than patch it piece by piece, we rebuilt from the ground up. Same inn, same restaurants, same events people love; every problem in this report is fixed in the new version. The new site is one fast page that Google can read, guests can book from, and AI tools like ChatGPT can quote when someone asks where to eat, stay, or get married near Rochester.

Results at a Glance

MEASURE	OLD SITE	NEW SITE
Checklist score	4 of 20 checks	20 of 20 checks
Homepage title in Google results	"THERE'S SO MUCH TO THE GOVERNORS INN! - Home"	"The Governor's Inn Restaurant & Hotel · Rochester, NH"
Page description for Google	None; Google invents one	Hand-written, with services and city
Main heading introducing the business	Zero on the page	Exactly one, plus a logical outline
Info labels Google & AI tools read	None at all	Full set: hotel, restaurant, hours, address, booking, FAQ
Wedding & events page	Does not exist	Dedicated section with photos
Guest questions answered (FAQ)	None	6 questions, quotable by AI tools

MEASURE	OLD SITE	NEW SITE
1990s code (font tags, layout tables)	17 font tags, 4 tables	Zero; modern semantic code
AI crawlers addressed in robots.txt	Not one	ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude welcomed
Business name consistency	Spelled two different ways	One spelling everywhere

Why the score gap matters most: a site that cannot be parsed cannot be cited; a site that cannot be cited is never the answer; the business that is not the answer does not get the call.

THE AUDIT

What Was Wrong, and What We Did About It

Left side: the problem, in plain terms. Right side: how the new site fixes it. Every item was confirmed in the live page source before we touched anything.

SERIOUS: COSTING YOU TRUST AND GUESTS**The site never introduces itself.**

There is no main heading anywhere on the page, no description, and the title misspells the inn's own name ("GOVERNORS" without the apostrophe). The one line Google shows the world is a shouted sentence with no location and no services.

The new site leads with one clear heading, a hand-written description, and the title "The Governor's Inn | Restaurant & Hotel · Rochester, NH", the exact string guests and engines search for.

Machines can read nothing about the business.

Zero structured data. No hotel, no restaurant, no hours, no address exists in any machine-readable form. Google and AI assistants cross-reference these labels literally; the current site gives them nothing to verify.

The new site carries a complete machine-readable graph: hotel, restaurant, bar, opening hours, address, booking action, and a six-question FAQ, all mirroring the visible text word for word.

The wedding business is invisible.

Live navigation: home, menu, music, gallery, holidays, contact. There is no weddings page. The inn's highest-ticket line of business cannot be found for any "wedding venue Rochester NH" search made this year.

Weddings and events get their own section: gardens, gazebo, tented courtyard, and ballroom, with real photos and a passage an engine can quote.

1990s code under the hood.

The homepage contains 17 font tags and 4 layout tables, markup that predates responsive design. Web credibility research has shown for two decades that roughly 75% of users judge an organization by its site design.

The new build is modern semantic code with zero legacy markup: one fast page, real photography, and a design that looks like the estate deserves.

BEING FOUND ON GOOGLE AND BY AI TOOLS

68% of searches now end without a click.

The winner in that world is the business the answer names. With no labels, no FAQ, and no extractable passages, the current site gives every engine nothing to name. The room, the table, and the wedding go to whoever gets named instead.

Every key fact (breakfast included, hours, live music, twenty rooms) now has a self-contained, quotable answer block. Extractable specifics improve AI visibility by up to ~40% in published research.

No guest question has a findable answer.

"Does The Governor's Inn include breakfast?" The fact is buried in an all-caps run-on paragraph no engine can cleanly lift. There is no FAQ anywhere on the site.

A six-question FAQ answers what guests actually ask (breakfast, rooms, takeout, music, weddings, location), each marked up so ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Google can quote it verbatim.

The inn's best story is untold.

The estate of brothers Huntley and Rolland Spaulding, both Governors of New Hampshire, run by the Ejarque family since 1992, appears nowhere on the live site. That story is the one asset no competitor can copy.

The new site tells the two-governors story on the page and in the machine-readable layer, anchoring the inn as an entity engines recognize.

AI referrals convert 4 to 5 times better, and never arrive.

Visitors referred by AI answers arrive pre-sold. The current site is structurally incapable of earning those referrals: its robots.txt considers no AI crawler at all.

The new robots.txt explicitly welcomes OAI-SearchBot, ChatGPT-User, PerplexityBot, and ClaudeBot, with the training-bot policy documented, and ships a sitemap for Google and Bing.

STRUCTURE & EASE OF USE

The booking handoff is unbranded.

Guests are sent to a generic third-party reservation domain (apps.gracesoft.com) with none of the inn's branding and no expectations set before the click.

Same proven booking engine, branded journey: the new site frames the handoff with a clear reserve action so guests know exactly what happens next.

Facts are scattered and inconsistent.

The address and phone appear once, unmarked. The name is spelled two ways on one page. Engines that cannot verify facts quietly drop the business from recommendations.

One consistent name, address, and phone everywhere a machine will ever read them, in the copy and in the labels, ready to match Google Business Profile and every directory.

STRUCTURE & EASE OF USE

Photography sells the property short.

Five small builder-processed images represent a historic estate with gardens, a gazebo, and twenty one-of-a-kind rooms.

Real photography of the estate, rooms, and food, every image named and described so Google Images knows exactly what it is looking at.

THE REBUILD

What You Have Now

A complete new website that keeps everything guests love (the restaurants, the music, the estate) in a fast, professional home that is unmistakably The Governor's Inn.

SECTION	WHAT IT DOES FOR YOU
Home	Full-bleed photography, the two-governors story, and answers to the questions guests ask most, with booking one tap away.
Dine	Spaulding Steak & Ale with hours, happy hour, Sunday brunch 8-2, and takeout via Toast.
Stay	Twenty original rooms, breakfast included with every stay, and a branded path into the booking engine.
The Garage	The seasonal beach-garden venue, live music Friday and Saturday 7-10, May through October.
Weddings & Events	Gardens, gazebo, tented courtyard, and ballroom, finally visible to every engagement-season search.
FAQ	Six real guest questions with direct answers, quotable by Google and every AI assistant.
Legal & technical	Search engine map, AI-crawler welcome, and machine-readable labels on every fact.

Built for the Way People Search Now

Many guests now skip Google and ask ChatGPT "where should we stay near Rochester NH?" The new site is built for both worlds: local signals for Google, quotable answers for AI assistants.

To Go Live: Three Small Steps

- 1. Point the domain.** We connect governorsinn.com to the new host: free hosting, automatic HTTPS.
- 2. Flip the launch switch.** We un-hide the site from Google and submit the sitemap to Google and Bing.
- 3. Claim and complete the Google Business Profile.** So the inn shows up on Maps with photos, hours, and booking links that match the site.

REFERENCE

Terms You Might Hear

A quick translation table for the jargon that comes up in conversations about websites.

TERM	WHAT IT ACTUALLY MEANS
SEO	Search Engine Optimization: everything done so the site shows up higher when people Google "restaurants Rochester NH" or "hotel near Rochester."
AI search / AEO	Making sure AI assistants like ChatGPT can read the site and mention The Governor's Inn when people ask for recommendations.
Structured data	Hidden labels on each page that tell Google and AI tools the inn's name, hours, rooms, and events in a format they understand instantly.
Title tag	The one line shown as the headline of your Google listing. Old site: a shouted sentence with a misspelled name. New site: name, services, and city.
NAP	Name, Address, Phone. Engines cross-check these against Google, Yelp, and directories; they must match everywhere, character for character.
Link preview	The card with an image and title that appears when a link is pasted into Facebook or a text. Old site: builder defaults. New site: branded, with a real photo.
301 redirect	A permanent forwarding address for a web page, so old links and Facebook posts land on the new site automatically.
Accessibility / ADA	Building the site so people with disabilities can use it. Also reduces legal risk.

Questions, or ready to launch?

Black Buoy | Coastal Web Craft | blackbuoy.net

Web design & development on the NH Seacoast